

Nikon COOLPIX 4300

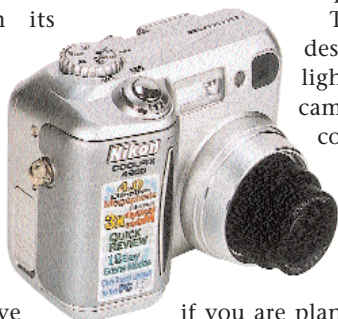
Pricey affair

The COOLPIX 4300 is a 4.0 Mega pixel digital camera with 3X optical zoom. Other features brought to you, courtesy Nikon, include 12 scene modes that help those new to digital cameras to get the best images easily. The camera is compact and the buttons are easily accessible. Like others in its class, it has a video-out jack so that you can preview the images on a TV screen, and is bundled with rechargeable Li-Ion batteries for a cost effective solution for extended use. The USB connection makes for easy transfer of pictures to the PC, and a dedicated transfer hotkey is provided to make the task even simpler.

However, when used in manual mode, adjusting settings such as white balance and resolution is a little complex. This is irritating if you need to change the settings frequently, while shooting outdoors. The COOLPIX 4300 also captures small movie clips, but the absence of a microphone does not let you record sound clips.

When tested for image quality at the highest resolution supported by the camera, we got mixed results. In the Auto mode, the outdoor images were impressive, with brilliant colour reproduction and details. However, when shooting indoors, images were captured in detail but

with a red tinge that was visible in PhotoShop, making the images look rather grainy. The camera also needs manual settings to get better depth of field. With everything set on Auto, you will not be able to get the desired depth in your photographs; which is a very important aspect of indoor photography.



The compact design and lightness of this camera makes it convenient for you to carry it on outdoor shoots.

However, if you are planning to take the camera with you on a long vacation, the 16 MB Compact flash memory might not be enough to store all your memories—at the highest setting in Fine mode, an image occupies between 1.8 MB and 2.3 MB. Using a lower setting of 1,280 pixels will bring the image size down to around 550 KB, which can also be printed later.

The camera is a good buy, if one plans to use it more outdoors than indoors, and is sufficient for the needs of the novice photographer.

SPECIFICATIONS

Weight 283 gms, 16 MB Compact Flash memory, 4.0 Mega pixel resolution, 3X optical zoom Nikkor lens, f2.8 to f13.4 aperture range, 8 to 1/1000 second shutter speed range, 1.5 inch LCD, 4 cm macro mode

Price: Rs 44,000
Contact: Aver Software Technologies Ltd.
Phone: 022-2673 2955/ 6/ 7/ 8
Fax: 022-2673 3116
E-mail: aver@averphoto.com
Web site: www.nikon.com

Nikon COOLPIX 4300 B+	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build Quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶

Antec Sonata Piano Black Super Mini Tower

A gamers box with style

Antec, well known for their high quality power supplies and cabinets, have been in the Indian market for while. The Sonata Piano Black Super Mini Tower cabinet comes from Antec's Lifestyle series.

The cabinet looks stunning with its polished jet black exterior finish. It has a lockable front panel door. When opened, it reveals the power button, optical drive bays and the floppy drive bay. It has two USB, one FireWire and two audio ports in front, neatly hidden behind a small gleaming silver roll over flap. The 'Antec' logos drilled on both the side panels double as ventilators. On the rear of the cabinet, there is a power switch and a switch to select the voltage.

The side panels have thumb screws that you can open with your hands, and are also lockable to prevent unauthorised access. The interior is a bit cramped, but better than other cabinets in the market. The quality of the materials used for constructing the cabinet is excellent, and it comes bundled with cables and connectors. A striking feature is the large 120 mm temperature controlled fan on the back panel. The sensor detects the interior temperature and varies the

fan speed accordingly. So if the temperature is lower, you get a quieter environment. There is also a provision to place another 120 mm fan behind the front panel, which would act as an air intake fan.

The cabinet has three 5.25 inch bays and six 3.5 inch bays. The 3.5 inch bays are displaced by 90 degrees (they face the side panelling)



and are detachable; this allows easy installation of hard disk drives—you can take the bay out, place the hard disk on rubber grommets provided on the bay, screw it in and place the whole bay back. The cabinet comes with

seven large power connectors and two small power connectors.

The Antec Sonata is priced at Rs 9,000, making it the most expensive cabinet targeted at the home segment. Considering its features, quality of construction, 380 Watt power supply, and 3 year replacement warranty, it is a great buy for gamers—if you can afford it.

SPECIFICATIONS

Mini Tower, Athlon or Pentium 4 compliant power supply, 380 Watt power rating, front mounted USB, FireWire and audio ports, Voltage (110/220) selector, 120 mm fan

Price: Rs 9,000
Contact: Cyber Space Abacus Pvt Ltd
Phone: 044-24917667
Fax: 044-52154188
E-mail: shunmugavel@theitdepot.com
Web site: www.antec-inc.com

Antec Sonata Piano Black Super Mini Tower B+	
Performance	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Build Quality	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Value for money	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
Features	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶
OVERALL	▶ ▶ ▶ ▶ ▶